



# SELECTED WORK 4: Will Wilson, Church Rock Spill Evaporation Ponds, Church Rock, New Mexico, Dinétaḥ, 2019 (56-58)

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Evaporation Ponds, Church Rock, New Mexico, Dinétah, 2019***

- **Will Wilson:** contemporary Diné (Navajo) artist
  - photography, sculpture, art history (Dinétah/Navajo Nation)
  - bachelor's in studio art & art history in 1993(Oberlin College)
  - Master of Fine Arts degree in 2002(University of New Mexico)
  - “Survey”: pollution in Dinétah



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- 4 Mil tons of uranium was extracted from the Dinétah
- Church Rock Spill is an aerial view
  - two ponds used to evaporate water contaminated with tailings(waste product from uranium mining-contains heavy metals and radium)
- dam holding contaminated water at the Church Rock uranium mill breached, sent 93 million gallons of radioactive liquid to the Dinétah



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- “Survey” emphasizes that the polluted lands were not unpopulated
  - “Survey” uses every definition
- Activities of military and mining industries repeated a false notion that Indigenous peoples basically don’t exist/matter
  - Wilson noticed this w/ Edward S. Curtis
    - created portraits in a studio using large format wet plate collodion photographs(response)
    - glass-plate negative: 8in.\*10in.(high detail)
    - emphasizing uniqueness



I thank

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You!

